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Second Order Difference Equations

Standard Form: $Y_{t+2} + a_1 Y_{t+1} + a_2 Y_t = C$

Time Path: $Y_t = Y_p + Y_c$

Particular Solution: Y_p

Case-I $\left. \begin{array}{l} y = k \\ a_1 + a_2 \neq -1 \end{array} \right\}$

$$Y_p = \frac{C}{1 + a_1 + a_2}$$

Q1: Find the Y_p from

$$Y_{t+2} - 3Y_{t+1} + 4Y_t = 6$$

$$Y_{t+2} + a_1 Y_{t+1} + a_2 Y_t = C$$

$$a_1 = -3, a_2 = 4, C = 6$$

$$\left. \begin{array}{l} a_1 + a_2 \neq -1 \\ -3 + 4 \neq -1 \\ +1 \neq -1 \end{array} \right\} \text{check if } a_1 + a_2 \neq -1$$

$$Y_p = \frac{6}{1 - 3 + 4} = \frac{6}{2}$$

$$Y_p = 3$$

Case-II $\left. \begin{array}{l} y = kt \\ a_1 + a_2 = -1 \end{array} \right\}$

$$Y_p = \frac{C}{a_1 + 2} t$$

Q2: Find Y_p if

$$Y_{t+2} + Y_{t+1} - 2Y_t = 12$$

$$a_1 = 1, a_2 = -2, C = 12$$

$$\text{check if } a_1 + a_2 = -1$$

$$1 - 2 = -1$$

$$-1 = -1$$

$$Y_p = \frac{12}{1 + 2} t$$

$$= \frac{12}{3} t$$

$$Y_p = 4t$$

Case-III $\left. \begin{array}{l} y = kt^2 \\ a_1 = -2, a_2 = 1 \end{array} \right\}$

$$Y_p = \frac{C}{2} t^2$$

Q3: Find Y_p if

$$Y_{t+2} - 2Y_{t+1} + Y_t = C = 18$$

$$a_1 = -2, a_2 = 1$$

$$Y_p = \frac{C}{2} t^2$$

$$Y_p = \frac{18}{2} t^2$$

$$Y_p = 9t^2$$